

Echoes Presentation Handoff

Three-page briefing for a fresh chat helping build the pitch deck

The core idea

Echoes is a location-based social discovery app that recreates the alive, imperfect internet feeling of around 2016 through collectible memory fragments, real-world movement, light mystery, and spontaneous low-stakes participation.

What competition this is for

This is for a designathon/case competition asking teams to design a digital product or experience that brings back what made the internet around 2016 feel special: imperfection, serendipitous discovery, archives and past selves, and low-pressure participation. Deliverables are a mid- to high-fidelity prototype plus a five-minute presentation and three-minute Q&A. The prototype matters a lot, but the presentation still has to make the concept feel intentional, differentiated, and grounded.

What makes this concept different

The user wants something that does not feel basic or easily copyable. A generic nostalgia app, BeReal clone, or scrapbook product is not enough. The strongest direction so far is a Pokémon GO style real-world layer, but instead of catching creatures, people discover fragments of human memory, digital leftovers, and atmosphere tied to places. That creates physical movement, unpredictability, social energy, and the sense that the world is hiding stories.

Topic	What the new chat should know
App name	Echoes is the locked-in name. The old name Breadcrumbs is no longer the direction.
Main fantasy	Walk through campus or a city and uncover glowing fragments left behind by others or by the system itself, like internet memories leaking into the real world.
Emotional target	Wonder, nostalgia, curiosity, and the weirdly intimate feeling of finding something not meant specifically for you, but meaningful anyway.
Prompt fit	Echoes hits serendipity, archived selves, imperfections, mystery, low-stakes play, and organic community encounters better than a static content platform.

Prototype state and locked product decisions

Topic	What the new chat should know
Map experience	The map is central. Fragments should feel like glowing orb markers, not normal pins. Locked fragments are greyed out. Active ones are colorful.
Interaction	When a user taps a fragment, there should be a soft expanding ripple effect before the card opens. Think signal, resonance, and discovery.
Demo setup	For the demo, the player start point should be hardcoded at Perth Hall.
Geographic scope	Western campus is the main demo zone right now. A basic London-wide view can exist so the app feels bigger, but Western should have the richer density.
UI tone	Modern, premium, atmospheric, and playful. Not childish, not literal Pokémon branding, and not ugly game UI. The user wants it polished and startup-level.
Fragment browser	There was interest in a playful Pokédex-style collection view, potentially inspired by the clustered app-bubble feeling of the Apple Watch home screen.
Design language	Visual cues should revolve around ripples, glow, resonance, memory, faint mystery, and collectibility. Echoes should look like a premium social product with game energy, not a loud gaming app.

What to emphasize about the product

Echoes is not just a map of posts. It is a system that turns movement into discovery and discovery into emotional attachment. Each fragment should feel more like stumbling across a digital relic than consuming a normal social feed post. The best explanation is that it combines the social unpredictability of 2016 internet culture with real-world wandering and collection mechanics.

What not to do

Do not frame it as just another nostalgia app, journaling app, AR app, or campus social map. Do not over-explain technical implementation inside the pitch. Do not lean too hard into copied Pokémon language. Also avoid making the story too abstract; the judges should instantly understand what users do, why it is fun, and why it matches the brief better than safer ideas.

Recommended presentation story

Topic	What the new chat should know
1. Hook	Open with a fast relatable image of how the old internet felt: random, messy, alive, and full of accidental discoveries. A TikTok-scroll style intro or compact Duolingo-like cold open was being considered.
2. Problem	The modern internet feels optimized, polished, and predictable. People consume more, discover less, and rarely feel the thrill of stumbling onto something strange and personal.
3. Insight	What people miss is not just old aesthetics. They miss unpredictability, local discovery, shared weirdness, and the feeling that the internet could still surprise them.
4. Solution	Introduce Echoes as a location-based layer of collectible fragments hidden around the real world. Users walk, uncover echoes, collect memories, and occasionally intersect with other people doing the same.
5. Why it wins	Tie directly to the brief: imperfection, serendipity, archives, and low-stakes participation are all built into the mechanic, not added as branding.
6. Prototype tour	Show the map, glowing fragment nodes, tap ripple, collection/card flow, and how Western campus works as the demo environment.
7. Close	End on the feeling: Echoes makes the internet feel alive again by putting mystery back into discovery.

Slide and speaking notes

The deck should probably stay tight: hook, problem, insight, solution, product walkthrough, why it fits the prompt, and close. Keep the business-model or long go-to-market talk very light unless needed for Q&A. Judges will care more about originality, clarity of concept, and quality of prototype than a corporate strategy deep dive.

Useful language for a fresh chat

Use phrasing like: Echoes turns places into memory landscapes. It restores serendipity by making discovery physical, local, and collectible. It is a social product with game structure, but the real reward is the feeling of finding something unexpectedly human. The pitch should sound confident, differentiated, and specific.

Main job for the next chat

Help craft a strong five-minute presentation that sells Echoes as the most original and best-brief-fit concept, while staying tightly aligned with the current prototype decisions and the user's preference for something bold, polished, and not basic.